assumed and asserted that the physical geography of India has partially influenced her history and shaped and moulded the course of her culture and civilisation.

It is evident that the objective of establishing such networks even for individual sects was to prevent any sense of regional parochialism from informing the faith of the worshipper, apart from, of course, seeking to disseminate their philosophy in the entirety of Bharat. Consequently, the deities and the devout belong to all of Bharat and all of Bharat belongs to the deities and the devout. This firm territorial connection between Indic OET systems and Bharat is what makes the Indic OET native to this land and, as a corollary, also explains why the OETs that inspire and drive Middle Eastern and European colonialities are not native to it. This is not a matter of subjective opinion or expression of xenophobia of any kind but is a statement of fact.

The other important layer that needs to be peeled away is that while the term ‘nationalism’ has indeed been used by scholars, such as Mookerji, to make a case for Indian nationalism based on Hindu nationalism, their use of ‘nationalism’ was meant to signify Bharat acting as a single political unit without taking away the civilisational character of Bharat. In that sense, Mookerji’s reference is to ‘civilisational nationalism’, that is, a living federal civilisation that acts as one insofar as the rest of the world is concerned. This is obviously very different from the European conception of a nation whose condition precedent is internal homogeneity.

At this juncture, before I proceed to discuss Mookerji’s views further on Bharat’s civilisation and his prescriptions for its politico-legal and social infrastructure, a relevant digression is warranted to credibly demonstrate the manner in which the sum and substance of Mookerji’s cogitation resonated with the framers of the Indian Constitution. While in the next section of this book and the sequels to this book I will examine if Bharat’s movement towards a constitution and the Constitution itself are informed by coloniality/colonial consciousness, there is indeed credible material that reasonably establishes the following:

1. The framers of the Constitution acknowledged the umbilical cord that connects independent Bharat with its civilisational history; and
2. The presence of ‘India that is Bharat’ in Article 1 of the Constitution is the consequence of civilisationally conscious suggestions that were